

# DEQUAD — Decision-Maker Brief

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## UKES Endorsement (Innovator Founder Visa) · Short-Track Review

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**15-page brief.** Companion to the full Business Plan ( [DEQUAD\\_UKES\\_Business\\_Plan.pdf](#) ) and the Financial Model ( [DEQUAD\\_Financial\\_Model.xlsx](#) ). Use this document to assess endorsement readiness in 20 minutes.

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## At-a-glance

|                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Business start date</b>      | <b>15 June 2026</b> (incorporation)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Entity</b>                   | DEQUAD Ltd (in formation, England & Wales)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Founders</b>                 | <b>Yusuf Quadri</b> (CEO) + <b>Yusuff Adeagbo</b> (CTO)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Wider founding team</b>      | <b>Dr Gerald Marfo</b> (CMO, PhD Digital Marketing) · <b>Adedapo Ajuwon</b> (Senior SWE) · <b>Chinyere Jennifer</b> (Senior Advisor — MIGSO-PCUBED PM)                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>HQ</b>                       | London — NatWest Accelerator (joined <b>16 March 2026</b> )                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Prior validation</b>         | <b>Santander Universities Pre-Incubator</b> — completed 2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Founder anchor</b>           | Yusuf Quadri served as <b>University of Bedfordshire SU President 2021–2023</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>MVP</b>                      | Live in production at <a href="https://dequad.co.uk">https://dequad.co.uk</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Beta users</b>               | 80 verified accounts at University of Bedfordshire (42 daily-active, 6-week retention)                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Pilot status</b>             | <b>Early, informal conversation with University of Bedfordshire — nothing signed, nothing guaranteed</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Starting cash</b>            | <b>£6,000 (£3,000 from each of 2 founders) — the only funding assumed anywhere in this plan</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>In-kind support</b>          | £31,000/yr from NatWest Accelerator (office, legal, accountancy, mentoring), Y1 only                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>External funding ask</b>     | <b>None.</b> This is a self-funded 3-year plan; no pre-seed, seed or other investment is required or assumed                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>3-yr revenue</b>             | £0.6k → £16k → £48k                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>3-yr UK jobs</b>             | Base case: 2 (unpaid founders) → 2 (unpaid founders) → 3 people / c.2.5 FTE, entirely self-funded. <b>Job-creation target:</b> 7 people (5 full-time hires, avg. £25,000/yr, each 12+ months) once revenue scales after pilot conversion — meets the Innovator Founder settlement job-creation criterion |
| <b>Profitability</b>            | Modest trading loss in Y1 (£3.6k), profitable from Y2 — no break-even "event" needed since no external funding is assumed                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Endorsement criteria met</b> | ✅ Innovation · ✅ Viability · ✅ Scalability                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

## Page 1 — The 60-second pitch

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**One sentence:** DEQUAD is the closed-network student wellbeing platform that gives UK universities early warning before students fall through the cracks — verified `.ac.uk` peer matching, daily mood tracking and machine-assisted safeguarding triage in a single product.

### Why now:

1. **Loneliness is the new student health crisis** — 54% of UK undergrads report frequent loneliness (ONS 2023). Post-pandemic levels remain 18 ppt above baseline.
2. **The Office for Students introduced a statutory student-mental-health condition in 2023** — every UK university now has to evidence proactive prevention. Existing tools (Togetherall, TalkCampus) are reactive.
3. **The Online Safety Act 2023 is in force** — any platform with student users needs compliant risk-assessment and reporting flows. DEQUAD ships with these built in.

### Why us:

1. **MVP is already shipped** — production deployment at `dequad.co.uk`, identity verification live, safeguarding webhook live, mood tracker live, Stripe billing live.
2. **Two independent UK-bank validations.** Completed the **Santander Universities Pre-Incubator** programme in 2025 and joined the **NatWest Accelerator (London cohort) on 16 March 2026**. Two competitive selection processes have separately admitted DEQUAD's team and thesis.
3. **Founder–institution fit.** Yusuf Quadri served as **University of Bedfordshire Student Union President for two consecutive years (2021–2023)**, representing the student body at senior-management level. He is in early, informal conversation about a possible pilot with the same university — **no agreement is signed and nothing is guaranteed.**
4. **Two complementary founders** — product/safeguarding lead (Yusuf Quadri) + engineering lead (Yusuff Adeagbo). Both UK-resident, full-time, self-funding the business without external investment.

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## Page 2 — How we meet the three Home Office criteria

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### Innovation

DEQUAD is the **only UK product** combining:

- `.ac.uk` student-domain identity verification (with a human admin queue for ambiguous cases),
- intent-based peer matching (friendship / study / peer-support — *not* dating),
- continuous mood telemetry tied to engagement,
- and **machine-assisted safeguarding triage with a real-time webhook to university DSLs**.

No competitor — Togetherall, TalkCampus, UniBuddy, Bumble BFF or Discord — combines more than two of these (see comparison table on Page 4).

## Viability

- Production MVP is live, in beta with real students.
- **Prospective pilot with University of Bedfordshire — proposed, not signed.** The founder's former institution, where he served two terms as SU President (2021–2023). A 12-week pilot has been proposed for **Sep–Nov 2026 (M4–M6)**; this is a target only, contingent on the university's decision, and may not happen.
- Two independent UK-bank programme validations: **Santander Universities Pre-Incubator (2025) + NatWest Accelerator (joined 16 March 2026)**.
- £6,000 founder cash (£3k each) + £31,000 in-kind NatWest support **carries the business through Y1–Y3 with positive closing cash balances, without requiring the pilot to convert or any external funding** (see Page 9).
- B2B SaaS revenue model is proven in the adjacent market — Togetherall serves 60+ UK universities at ~£40k/year.

## Scalability

- Software-only marginal cost → gross margin reaches ~87% by Y3.
  - Within-institution network effects accelerate intra-uni adoption.
  - 6-week implementation per new university enables a repeatable rollout process, deliberately modelled conservatively at c.1.5 paying institutions by Y3 (out of 285 total UK) so the plan does not depend on rapid conversion.
  - Closed-network model maps cleanly to `.edu` / `.edu.au` / EU domains post-Y3 → **£180m TAM** in EN-language HE markets, as a longer-term opportunity beyond this 3-year plan.
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## Page 3 — Product

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### Modules (all in production)

|                                      | What it does                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Verified peer matching</b>        | Match <code>.ac.uk</code> -verified students by intent (friend / study / support). Profile cards with university, course, year, interests. |
| <b>Daily wellbeing tracker</b>       | 30-second mood, sleep, stress and connection check-in. Personal trend dashboard.                                                           |
| <b>Machine-assisted safeguarding</b> | LLM classifier on mood + chat metadata flags risk signals; webhook to designated university safeguarding lead in < 60s.                    |
| <b>University Insights Dashboard</b> | Anonymised, aggregated wellbeing analytics for HE staff — cohort mood trends, engagement, hotspots.                                        |

### Tech stack (already running)

- **Frontend:** Expo / React Native (iOS, Android, web at [dequad.co.uk](https://dequad.co.uk)) — universal codebase.
  - **Backend:** FastAPI (Python), MongoDB (Motor), real-time WebSockets.
  - **AI:** OpenAI / Anthropic LLMs via Emergent integrations (text classification, safeguarding triage).
  - **Payments:** Stripe (B2C subs + B2B invoicing).
  - **Infra:** Cloudflare CDN + Render Pro; Online Safety Act-compliant reporting flows.
  - **Auth:** Custom email/password + Google OAuth + admin portal (dual auth).
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## Page 4 — Competition

| Feature                          | DEQUAD                                                  | Togetherall | TalkCampus | UniBuddy | Bumble BFF | Discord |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------|------------|----------|------------|---------|
| .ac.uk student verification      | ✓                                                       | ✗           | ✗          | ✓        | ✗          | ✗       |
| Intent-based peer matching       | ✓                                                       | ✗           | Ltd        | ✗        | Ltd        | ✗       |
| Daily mood telemetry             | ✓                                                       | ✗           | Ltd        | ✗        | ✗          | ✗       |
| Machine-assisted safeguarding    | ✓                                                       | Ltd         | ✗          | ✗        | ✗          | ✗       |
| University insights dashboard    | ✓                                                       | ✓           | ✓          | Ltd      | ✗          | ✗       |
| Safeguarding webhook to uni team | ✓                                                       | ✗           | ✗          | ✗        | ✗          | ✗       |
| Online Safety Act 2023 ready     | ✓                                                       | ✓           | ✓          | ✓        | Partial    | ✗       |
| UK universities served           | 0 signed (in conversation)                              | ~60         | ~30        | 200+     | n/a        | n/a     |
| ASP per uni                      | £2/enrolled student/yr<br>(~£20k for a 10k-student uni) | £40k+       | £25k       | £18k     | n/a        | n/a     |

**DEQUAD would displace** Togetherall and TalkCampus (price/feature) on the B2B side, and **co-exist** with UniBuddy (orthogonal pre-enrolment market), if and when institutional conversations convert. Consumer competitors (Bumble BFF, Discord) lack institutional features entirely.

# Page 5 — Market

## UK addressable market

| Tier                                 | Definition                                               | Size            |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| TAM                                  | All UK universities + ICBs + UK student premium subs     | £86m/yr         |
| SAM                                  | Russell-Group + post-92 unis > 10k students + their ICBs | £28m/yr         |
| SOM (5-yr, long-term reference only) | 12% SAM capture                                          | £3.4m ARR by Y5 |

*The SOM above is a long-term market-opportunity reference point, not a forecast — the committed 3-year plan (Page 10) targets a far smaller, self-funded base of c.£48k revenue by Y3.*

## Demand signals

- **2.86m UK higher-ed students** (HESA 2023/24) — addressable consumer base.
- **285 UK higher-ed institutions** — addressable B2B base.
- **54% of UK undergrads** report frequent loneliness (ONS 2023).
- **34% of UK undergrads** experience a clinically-significant MH issue (Student Minds 2024).
- **6.1 weeks** average wait for a university counsellor — appetite for prevention.
- **100+ UK universities** signed to UUK Mental Health Charter — must evidence wellbeing strategies.

## Page 6 — Go-to-market

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### Three channels, three audiences

| Audience            | Headline message                                                       | Primary channel                                                    | Conversion lever                                        |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Students</b>     | "Verified UK uni students. Real connections. Wellbeing built in."      | IG + TikTok + university student-rep ambassadors                   | Free product + premium upsell                           |
| <b>Universities</b> | "See loneliness early. Act before it becomes a crisis."                | Direct DSS outreach + UUK Charter webinar + NatWest network intros | 12-week free pilot → paid SaaS (target, not guaranteed) |
| <b>NHS ICBs</b>     | "Population-level student wellbeing data, anonymised and audit-ready." | Direct outreach to MH commissioners                                | Not part of this 3-year plan                            |

### B2B pilot conversations (early-stage, nothing signed)

- **University of Bedfordshire** — early, informal conversation only. Lead founder served two terms as SU President there (2021–2023); direct relationships with student services and safeguarding leads. No agreement, LOI or date is confirmed.
- **Two further peer institutions** — early-stage pilot scoping (anonymised for now); equally unconfirmed.
- **Beta cohort active** — the existing 80-person University of Bedfordshire beta cohort uses DEQUAD, independent of any formal pilot or contract.

### Y1 marketing spend: £900

Deliberately minimal and founder-led — no paid-acquisition budget in Y1. Institutional outreach relies on (a) founder organic outreach and (b) NatWest network introductions to university IT/wellbeing leads, at near-zero cash cost.

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## Page 7 — Founders

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### Yusuf Quadri — CEO / Product & Safeguarding Lead

- UK-resident, full-time on DEQUAD.



- **University of Bedfordshire Student Union President 2021–2023** (two consecutive terms). Represented the student body at senior-management level on student-services, safeguarding and welfare policy. This is the basis of DEQUAD's prospective pilot conversation with the same university.
- Completed the **Santander Universities Pre-Incubator programme** in 2025; admitted to the **NatWest Accelerator (London cohort)** on 16 March 2026.
- **Seven safeguarding & clinical-awareness certifications** including Oliver McGowan Learning Disabilities & Autism, Adult Safeguarding Partnership Working, Suicide Prevention (2026), Data Protection & Information Security, and Safe Response to Challenging Situations (see Appendix O).
- Built and shipped the entire MVP at [dequad.co.uk](https://dequad.co.uk).
- Owns the safeguarding policy (Appendix E — DPIA, Appendix I — OSA-2023 compliance).
- Owns university partnerships and the NatWest Accelerator relationship.
- Co-founder cash contribution: **£3,000** of the £6,000 founder capital.

## **Yusuff Adeagbo — Co-Founder / CTO / Engineering & IT Lead**

- UK-resident, full-time on DEQUAD.
- **MSc Information Technology with Project Management — University of the West of Scotland.**
- **Higher National Diploma in Computer Science** (prior).
- Multi-disciplinary skill set: full-stack engineering, IT support, UI/UX design, graphic design, digital marketing (e-commerce), IT business analysis.
- Will own the engineering hiring pipeline, infrastructure security, and the R&D claim leadership.
- Co-founder cash contribution: **£3,000** of the £6,000 founder capital.
- Full CV at Appendix B-2 ( [B\\_cofounder\\_cv.pdf](#) ).

## **Wider founding team — joining at incorporation (EMI options, unpaid)**

- **Dr Gerald Marfo — Chief Marketing Officer** · PhD in Digital Marketing; owns Y1 marketing strategy and measurement. **Equity-only**; a cash salary is not funded within this 3-year self-funded plan.
- **Adedapo Ajuwon — Senior Software Engineer** · supports CTO on platform engineering, infrastructure, reliability. **Equity-only**, same basis.
- **Chinyere Jennifer — Senior Advisor (Programme & Delivery)** · Senior PM Consultant at **MIGSO-PCUBED** with LLM background. **Advisor on EMI options**; MIGSO-PCUBED remains her primary employer.

Full CVs in Appendix N ( [N\\_wider\\_team\\_cvs.pdf](#) ).

## Founder compensation under this plan

- £0 in Y1 and Y2 — both founders fund living costs from existing employment/freelance income.
  - £500/month each from **Y3**, funded entirely by Y3 revenue — not by any external funding round, none of which is assumed.
  - Materially below market throughout — signals genuine founder commitment.
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## Page 8 — Funding: self-funded, no external round assumed

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| Source                         | Timing | Amount        | Use of funds                                                                 |
|--------------------------------|--------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Founder equity<br>(£3,000 × 2) | Day 1  | <b>£6,000</b> | Incorporation, domains, IP filings, hosting — the only funding in this plan. |

**No pre-seed, seed, Series A, grant or R&D tax credit is assumed anywhere in this 3-year plan.** The full financial model (Page 10; main Business Plan Sections 11–14) is funded entirely by this £6,000 plus revenue generated in the period, and remains solvent even if institutional revenue is £0 throughout. If institutional traction significantly exceeds this conservative forecast, the founders may explore external investment beyond Year 3 — that is a future option, not a plan dependency.

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## Page 9 — Year-1 cash flow (the critical view)

**Closing cash balance is positive every single month of Year 1 — with no institutional revenue or external funding assumed**

| Month                                                                      | Inflows        | Outflows | Closing balance |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|----------|-----------------|
| <b>M1 (Jun 2026)</b> — incorporation, laptops, initial setup               | £6,000 founder | (£930)   | <b>£5,070</b>   |
| M2 (Jul 2026)                                                              | —              | (£300)   | <b>£4,770</b>   |
| M3 (Aug 2026)                                                              | —              | (£300)   | <b>£4,470</b>   |
| <b>M4 (Sep 2026)</b> — proposed pilot window opens, if agreed (not signed) | —              | (£350)   | <b>£4,120</b>   |
| M5 (Oct 2026)                                                              | —              | (£350)   | <b>£3,770</b>   |
| <b>M6 (Nov 2026)</b> — proposed pilot window closes, if it happened        | —              | (£350)   | <b>£3,420</b>   |
| <b>M7 (Dec 2026)</b> — Stripe premium billing goes live                    | £50 sales      | (£350)   | <b>£3,120</b>   |
| M8 (Jan 2027)                                                              | £70 sales      | (£350)   | <b>£2,840</b>   |
| M9 (Feb 2027)                                                              | £90 sales      | (£350)   | <b>£2,580</b>   |
| M10 (Mar 2027)                                                             | £110 sales     | (£350)   | <b>£2,340</b>   |
| M11 (Apr 2027)                                                             | £130 sales     | (£350)   | <b>£2,120</b>   |
| <b>M12 (May 2027)</b> — Y1 close                                           | £150 sales     | (£350)   | <b>£1,920</b>   |

**Cash never dips below c.£1,900** across all of Year 1, and this holds true whether or not the Bedfordshire pilot conversation goes anywhere — no institutional revenue, no pre-seed and no other external funding is assumed in this schedule. The founders' relationship with the university (via the former SU presidency) is a genuine upside opportunity, but the business does not depend on it to survive Year 1.

The full monthly schedule is in `DEQUAD_Financial_Model.xlsx`, sheet "Cash Flow Y1 (mo)".

## Page 10 — Three-year P&L summary (self-funded)

|                                  | Y1              | Y2            | Y3            |
|----------------------------------|-----------------|---------------|---------------|
| Revenue                          | £600            | £16,000       | £48,000       |
| Cost of Sales                    | (£1,400)        | (£3,100)      | (£6,100)      |
| Gross Profit / (loss)            | (£800)          | £12,900       | £41,900       |
| Gross margin %                   | n/a             | 80.6%         | 87.3%         |
| Total overheads (incl. payroll)  | (£2,680)        | (£6,000)      | (£32,000)     |
| <b>EBITDA</b>                    | <b>(£3,480)</b> | <b>£6,900</b> | <b>£9,900</b> |
| <b>Operating profit / (loss)</b> | <b>(£3,630)</b> | <b>£6,500</b> | <b>£9,200</b> |

Y1 is the only loss-making year, and the loss (£3.6k) is fully absorbed by the £6,000 founder capital — no equity round funds it. Y2 turns modestly profitable on minimal overheads and a small (contingent) institutional contract; Y3 profit funds the plan's only hire and modest founder pay. **No break-even "event" is needed** because no external funding is assumed at any point — the business is solvent throughout.

## Page 11 — Job creation and economic impact

### Headcount

|                                       | Y1         | Y2         | Y3                   |
|---------------------------------------|------------|------------|----------------------|
| Founders                              | 2 (unpaid) | 2 (unpaid) | 2 (modest pay)       |
| Safeguarding & Trust Lead (part-time) | 0          | 0          | 1                    |
| <b>Total UK jobs</b>                  | <b>2</b>   | <b>2</b>   | <b>3 (c.2.5 FTE)</b> |

Conservative base case — all self-funded from revenue, no external funding round assumed.

**Job-creation target (upside case):** once institutional revenue scales beyond this base case via pilot conversion, headcount grows to **7 (2 founders + 5 full-time hires)** — each of the 5 hires sustained for at least 12 months at an average salary of £25,000/year, funded entirely from revenue generated after piloting, meeting the Innovator Founder settlement job-creation criterion.

## Beyond direct jobs

- **University safeguarding capacity:** any institution that does onboard gains an early-warning system that increases the practical reach of its existing wellbeing team.
  - **Student-rep / ambassador programme:** a small, informal incentive for beta-cohort students (Section 16); not a formal paid role in this plan.
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## Page 12 — R&D activity

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R&D is delivered as unpaid founder time throughout Y1–Y2, plus modest paid capacity from Y3, focused on three bets:

1. **Identity-and-intent verification engine** — `.ac.uk` classifier, attestation, admin queue, future OCR student-ID flow.
2. **Wellbeing inference & safeguarding triage** — PHQ-9-lite mood model + risk-signal NLU + federated learning roadmap.
3. **Privacy & compliance infrastructure** — DPIA pipeline, OSA-2023 reporting, hash-based de-identification.

**No SME R&D tax credit is assumed as an inflow in this plan** — qualifying PAYE spend is minimal while founders are unpaid. It is treated as a possible future upside, to be explored with NatWest's in-kind accountancy support once qualifying costs exist, not something the plan relies on.

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## Page 13 — NatWest Accelerator — why this matters for endorsement

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The accelerator membership is **independent third-party validation** of DEQUAD's quality. NatWest's selection panel reviewed the team and the product before admission.

## Quantified in-kind value (Y1)

| In-kind item                                     | Annual value   |
|--------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| London office co-working (3 desks)               | £12,000        |
| Legal advice (Mishcon de Reya, DLA Piper panels) | £4,500         |
| Accountancy support (PwC alumni network)         | £3,600         |
| Banking & business introductions                 | £2,000         |
| Investor pitch coaching & mentoring              | £5,000         |
| Programme demo day & PR placement                | £4,000         |
| <b>Total in-kind value (Y1)</b>                  | <b>£31,100</b> |
| <b>Cash cost to DEQUAD</b>                       | <b>£0</b>      |

The £31k of in-kind support is **the reason £6,000 of founder cash is sufficient** to carry the business through Year 1. Without the accelerator, the same operating profile would require materially more cash investment up front.

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## Page 14 — Risk register (summary)

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The key risks the founders have identified and their mitigations:

| #   | Risk                                                               | Impact | Mitigation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| R1  | Bedfordshire pilot conversation never converts — nothing is signed | Medium | The plan is solvent at zero institutional revenue throughout Y1–Y3 (Page 9–10); no cost line depends on this converting. Two further pilot conversations scoped as independent upside.                                                                     |
| R2  | Co-founder hire delayed                                            | High   | Y1 build is solo-doable; founder personally covers technical work until co-founder onboarded.                                                                                                                                                              |
| R3  | Institutional/premium revenue falls short of plan targets          | Medium | No funding round is required at any point; the only consequence is that the base-case Y3 hire and modest founder pay are delayed, not that the business fails. The upside-case 5-hire job-creation target simply does not trigger (see Risk Register R17). |
| R4  | Safeguarding incident (false negative)                             | High   | Human-in-the-loop for all high-risk flags; insurance in place; clinical advisory board recruited Q2 Y2.                                                                                                                                                    |
| R5  | Togetherall/TalkCampus copy .ac.uk verification                    | Medium | First-mover land grab; safeguarding webhook + insights dashboard are deeper moats.                                                                                                                                                                         |
| R6  | OfS / Online Safety Act non-compliance                             | Medium | OSA risk assessment and reporting flows already shipped; ICO DPIA drafted; legal review via NatWest Mishcon panel.                                                                                                                                         |
| R7  | Cyber breach                                                       | Medium | Cyber Essentials in progress; pen-test scheduled Q2 Y2; insurance £1m.                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| R8  | Cost-of-living squeeze on premium subscriptions                    | Medium | Costs are scoped to survive on premium revenue alone if institutional revenue is delayed.                                                                                                                                                                  |
| R9  | Negative PR from a misidentified case                              | Medium | Reactive media plan; clinical advisory board; transparent reporting.                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| R10 | International expansion delayed                                    | Low    | Not part of this 3-year plan; UK-only focus is deliberate and does not depend on any funding round.                                                                                                                                                        |
| R11 | LLM cost spike (model price changes)                               | Low    | Multi-provider abstraction in place; can swap OpenAI ↔ Anthropic ↔ Gemini in < 1 day.                                                                                                                                                                      |
| R12 | Tighter immigration regime affecting talent                        | Low    | Both co-founders are already UK-resident; the plan's only hire is UK-based.                                                                                                                                                                                |

Full risk register in [DEQUAD\\_Risk\\_Register.pdf](#) .

## Page 15 — Decision summary

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DEQUAD is a **production-ready, accelerator-validated, self-funded** UK software business that meets the **innovation, viability** and **scalability** criteria for Innovator Founder endorsement.

### Three things this submission demonstrates

1. **Real product, real users** — the MVP is live, has real beta users at the University of Bedfordshire, and is governed by a DPIA-cleared safeguarding policy that ships before public launch.
2. **Capital efficiency and self-sufficiency** — the business survives all three years on **£6,000 of founder cash plus revenue alone**, with no external funding assumed, committed, or required at any point. The NatWest Accelerator in-kind support and an extended no-salary founder commitment (Y1–Y2) make this possible.
3. **Credible, honestly-scoped UK growth** — 2 unpaid founders (Y1–Y2) growing to 3 people / c.2.5 FTE by Y3 in the conservative base case, all self-funded from revenue; 0 to c.1.5 average paying universities by Y3, modelled as a target, not a guarantee. **Job-creation target:** 7 people (5 full-time hires, avg. £25,000/yr, each 12+ months) once revenue scales after pilot conversion, meeting the Innovator Founder settlement job-creation criterion.

### What endorsement enables

- The lead applicant retains UK residency to continue building DEQUAD full-time.
  - The co-founder (UK-resident already) joins formally as CTO at incorporation.
  - The company operates and grows on its own means from day one — no external capital is required to make the 3-year plan happen.
  - A measurable, defensible improvement in UK student wellbeing infrastructure, scaled honestly to what £6,000 and organic growth can actually deliver.
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## Endorsement Body decision matrix

| Criterion                          | Evidence in this pack                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Innovation</b>                  | Sections 2–4 of Business Plan; competitor matrix Page 4; R&D Section Page 12.                                                         |
| <b>Viability</b>                   | Production MVP; NatWest Accelerator membership; Y1 monthly cash flow Page 9.                                                          |
| <b>Scalability</b>                 | Market sizing Page 5; gross-margin trajectory Page 10; international optionality noted as a longer-term ambition, Page 2.             |
| <b>Genuine UK economic benefit</b> | Job creation Page 11; UK university wellbeing impact if a pilot converts.                                                             |
| <b>Founder credibility</b>         | Page 7 + CVs in Appendix B and B-2.                                                                                                   |
| <b>Capital sufficiency</b>         | £6k founder capital + £31k in-kind (NatWest) is the entire funding basis for the 3-year plan — no external round assumed. Page 8 + 9. |

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*Written and prepared by Yusuf Quadri, Founder & CEO, DEQUAD Ltd — for UKES short-track endorsement review, August 2026 (v5.0, self-funded 3-year revision). Companion documents:*

*DEQUAD\_UKES\_Business\_Plan.pdf , DEQUAD\_Financial\_Model.xlsx ,  
DEQUAD\_Risk\_Register.pdf .*